

Week 4 / Thursday

Rick Wysocki

Why Do We Revise?

- ▶ Most importantly, **learning** from our successes and our failures
- ▶ Reworking / rethinking our writing
- ▶ Metacognition / reflection

Metacognition / Reflection

From “Reflective Writing and the Revision Process: What Were You Thinking?” by Sandra Giles:

"Reflection helps you to develop your intentions (purpose), figure out your relation to your audience, uncover possible problems with your individual writing processes, set goals for revision, make decisions about language and style, and the list goes on. In a nutshell, it helps you develop more insight into and control over composing and revising processes."

What Revision is Not

- ▶ Simply "touching up" a draft
- ▶ Finishing an incomplete draft
- ▶ "Fixing" your "grammar"

Global vs. Local Concerns



Figure: Photo by Joshua Rawson-Harris on Unsplash

Global vs. Local Concerns

- ▶ Global:
 - ▶ Argument
 - ▶ Structure
 - ▶ Ideas
 - ▶ Connections between information
- ▶ Local:
 - ▶ Sentence level
 - ▶ Grammar / usage
 - ▶ Stylistic

What Are Revision Strategies That Work for You?

Writing Reflection Activity: Part 1

Spend a few minutes and locate the most powerful or effective moments of insight in your current draft. Consider where you feel you are making your best points or most sense about the topic. Highlight or underline those sections.

Writing Reflection Activity: Part 2

Now you'll reread and extend those powerful moments. You'll write 2-4 sentences for each one that deepen and extend the idea. If you're not sure how to start, think about the implications of your original statement. For example:

Original Statement: [Text] doesn't use Confucian principles as well as it could have.

Implications: In what ways could it have used Confucian principles? How, specifically, would doing so have improved the text? What is an example of what this would look like?

Writing Reflection: Part 3

Read through your paper draft and take notes on what you still need to work on. Examples might include your larger, argument, quotations, analysis, introduction, transitions, etc. Try to be as specific as possible.

Writing Reflection: Part 4

Finally, consider what is **not** in your draft. What is missing? What needs to be included or developed further?

Peer Review: What Works?